Matthew Mettler

Ph.D. Candidate in Political Science
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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Political Science, University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign *Expected May 2027*

Dissertation: Fact–Opinion Differentiation Among Citizens: The Role of Partisan Identity, Cognitive Resources, and Media Cues

Committee: Jeffery Mondak (Chair), Damarys Canache, Brian Gaines, and Thomas Rudolph

M.A. in International Relations, University of South Dakota 2019

B.S. in Political Science, South Dakota State University 2013

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Primary Fields: American Politics; Political Methodology

Substantive Interests: Political Behavior; Public Opinion; Political Communication; Misinformation; Democratic Accountability; Policy Feedback; Institutional Trust

Methods: Survey and experimental research; measurement; causal inference; compositional data analysis; applied statistical analysis and R programming

PUBLICATIONS

Book

Hibbing, M. V., **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J. J., & Raynal, I. R. (forthcoming, 2027). *(Mis)understanding the Other Side: How Americans Explain Opposing Political Views*. Temple University Press.

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

Henderson, E., **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J. J., & Peffley, M. (2026). Experiential spillover in public views of police and courts. *Journal of Law and Courts*, 14(1), 238–258. [Article]

Canache, D., Knoll, N. J., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2025). Indigenous quotas and symbolic representation in Latin America. *Journal of Politics in Latin America*, 18(3), 361-384. [Article]

McClinton, K. S., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2025). Conceptualizing and measuring structural overlap in the political attitudes and orientations of multidimensional groups. *Social Science Quarterly*, 106(3), e70038. [Article]

Pagán Márquez, A. S., Djupe, P. A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2024). Was there an enthusiasm gap? Examining support for Donald Trump among evangelicals and nonevangelicals. *Politics and Religion*, 17(3), 410–430. [Article]

Mettler, M., & Mondak, J. J. (2024). Fact–opinion differentiation. *Harvard Kennedy School Misinformation Review, 5*(2). [Article]

JOB MARKET PAPER

Mettler, M. Accuracy, Bias, or Noise in Political Judgments? A Compositional Approach to Fact–Opinion Classification.

MANUSCRIPTS

Revise and Resubmit

Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. Guardrails, Accomplices, or Bystanders? Citizen Response to Undemocratic Elite Cues. *Democratization*.

Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. Three Tests of the Political Impact of Individual-Level Variation in the Negativity Bias. *Journal of Experimental Political Science*.

Working Papers

Mettler, M. Nudging Away from Bias: Accuracy Prompting and Partisan Fact–Opinion Classification.

Mettler, M. Facts by Association: How Media & Partisan Cues Shape Political Fact–Opinion Classification.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J. J., & Strojny, L. M. There but for Misfortune: The Impact of Economic Information and Misinformation on Voting in the 2024 U.S. Presidential Election.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. A Multidimensional Approach to Measuring Misinformation Response Tendencies.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. A Targeted Strategy for Improving the Mass Public's Capacity to Identify True and False Political Claims.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. Creating Measures of Retrospective Perceptions beyond Economic Indicators.

Griffin, C., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. Exploring the Impact of Alternate Framings of Czechia on American Attitudes towards Czechs.

Mullins, S., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. Deep in Thought or Deeply Biased? Cognitive Ability and Motivated Reasoning.

Lim, Y., & **Mettler, M.** Moral Tradeoffs in Candidate Choice: When Do Evangelical Voters Excuse Misconduct?

POLICY REPORTS AND PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP

Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2023). Eviction expectations in the aftermath of the pandemic moratoria. *University of Illinois College of Law Legal Studies Research Paper*, No. 24-06. [Article]

Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2023). Texas's movement to online court is sensible, but more study should follow. *Voice for the Defense*, 20–22. [Article]

Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2022). Race and eviction during the pandemic. *Institute of Government and Public Affairs Policy Spotlight*. [Article]

Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2022). Courts and the housing market. *News-Gazette*. [Article]

Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, Wilson, R. F., & Miller, A. (2022). The impact of COVID-19 on state court proceedings: Five key findings. *Institute of Government and Public Affairs Policy Spotlight*. [Article]

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Mullins, S., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2026). Deep in Thought or Deeply Biased? Cognitive Ability and Motivated Reasoning. Paper presented at the American Political Science Association's Annual Meeting, Boston, Massachusetts.

Griffin, C., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2026). Exploring the Impact of Alternate Framings of Czechia on American Attitudes towards Czechs. Paper presented at the American Political Science Association's Annual Meeting, Boston, Massachusetts.

Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2026). The political impact of individual-level variation in the negativity bias. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the International Society of Political Psychology, Newcastle, United Kingdom.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2026). Economic realities, partisan fictions: Facts, perceptions, and partisan bias in economic voting. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, Illinois.

Henderson, E., **Mettler, M.**, Mondak, J. J., & Peffley, M. (2025). Experiential spillover in public views of police and courts. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the American Political Science Association, Vancouver, British Columbia, Canada.

Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2025). Elite cues can induce the erosion of democratic support: Evidence from two U.S. surveys. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the International Society of Political Psychology, Prague, Czech Republic.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2025). Fostering political lie detection. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, Illinois.

Betchley, J., Lewis, A., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2025). Measuring and modeling misinformation: A strategy for assessing the relative prevalence of partisan and residual error. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, Illinois.

Lim, Y., & **Mettler, M.** (2025). When to tolerate immorality by elected officials and when not to. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, Illinois.

Canache, D., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2025). Elite cues and Americans' support for authoritarian world leaders. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the Southern Political Science Association, San Juan, Puerto Rico.

Canache, D., Knoll, N. J., **Mettler, M.**, & Mondak, J. J. (2024). Indigenous quotas and perceived representation in Latin America. Paper presented at the Annual Meeting of the European Political Science Association, Cologne, Germany.

Gaines, B. J., Mazzone, J., **Mettler, M.**, & Wilson, R. F. (2022). Race and eviction during the pandemic. Paper presented at the Race and Social Justice Symposium, Champaign, Illinois.

TEACHING AND MENTORING

Instructor of Record

The U.S. Supreme Court	Summer 2026
Politics and the Media	Fall 2025
Introduction to American Politics (Co-instructor)	Spring 2025
Introduction to Politics	Fall 2024

Teaching Assistant

State Government in the United States	Fall 2026
Introduction to International Relations	Spring 2026
Strategic International Relations	Spring 2024
Junior Honors Seminar	Fall 2023
Introduction to Political Behavior	Fall 2023

Graduate Methods Instruction

Political Science Math Camp: Probability and R Programming	2025
Political Science Math Camp: Probability and R Programming	2024
Political Science Math Camp: Linear Regression and R Programming	2023

Undergraduate Research Mentoring

Josh Ellison 2026

Challenging the Partisan Voter: A Two-Dimensional Model of Vote Choice Beyond Ideology

Undergraduate Thesis Best Poster Award, UIUC Department of Political Science

Nathan Knoll 2025

Effects of Legislative Gender Quotas on Political Efficacy

Kenneth Dolin 2025

The Role of the Poll: Polling (Dis)trust and Increased Voter Turnout

Honorable Mention, Undergraduate Thesis Best Poster Award, UIUC Department of Political Science

Kennedy McClinton 2024

Conceptualizing and Measuring Structural Overlap in the Political Attitudes and Orientations of Multidimensional Groups

Vindhya Kalipi 2024

I'm Just a Bill: The Impact of Civic Education on Democratic Engagement

Alondra S. Pagán Márquez 2023

Was There an Enthusiasm Gap? Examining Support for Donald Trump among Evangelicals and Nonevangelicals

Emma Henderson 2023

Experiential Spillover in Public Views of Police and Courts

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

Institute of Government and Public Affairs 2021–2022

- Collaborated with a team of scholars investigating the effects of COVID-19 on state court systems.
- Prepared policy reports for publication through the Institute's Access to Justice Initiative.
- Conducted in-depth interviews with court officials for policy research projects.

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND GRANTS

Dissertation Completion Fellowship ($12,000), University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign 2026

MPSA Travel Grant, Department of Political Science 2025, 2026

List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent by Their Students, University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign 2025, 2026

Summer Dissertation Fellowship ($3,000), Department of Political Science 2025

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Reviewer

Political Behavior	2026
Institute of Government and Public Affairs (policy-report review)	2026
Harvard Kennedy School Misinformation Review	2026

Departmental Service

Faculty Search Committee, Graduate Representative	2024
Political Science Math Camp Committee	2023–2025

MEDIA AND PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

The 21st Show, Illinois Public Media	2024
WTAX, Illinois statewide radio	2023
WCIA-TV, Champaign, Illinois	2023
CBS Chicago Morning Show	2023

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

American Political Science Association

International Society of Political Psychology

Midwest Political Science Association